
4. Make your bed

We also switch our sheets to flannel for the winter. We supplement each bed with a wool blanket and an extra quilt or two. In the upstairs room (where it is coldest), the adults have an electric blanket set on low or a heated mattress pad for the really cold nights. It's amazing how peacefully you can sleep with a chill to the air and your body comfortably warm.

5. Top it off

My ultra-sexy nightwear consists of sweats or long underwear with wool socks. I also wear a stocking cap on the colder nights. It keeps me feeling snug, and I have less bed head in the morning. (Plus, my husband thinks it's cute!)

6. Spice things up

Cold sandwiches take a sabbatical for the winter at my house. We bust out the chili recipes, Crock-Pot fare, and make all of our evening meals a bit zestier than normal. Most of it is purely psychological, but it does help keep a warmth about the dinner table. (Another perk is the economics of spicy meals. Many of them are dirt cheap.)

7. Keep hydrated

Our hot cocoa bill is higher than normal during the winter. We replace our chocolate milk with hot chocolate. (Ovaltine works well for a vitamin-packed alternative.) I enjoy herbal teas and decaf coffees in the evenings. Hot apple cider kept simmering on the stove not only tastes delicious, but it also keeps your home smelling yummy. Replacing your cold drinks with hot ones can keep you toasty any time of day.

8. Snuggle

I'll admit to letting my kids jump in bed with us a bit more in the winter time. The toddlers are like radiant heaters that require no electricity. Just toss a three-year-old in the mix for an instant 10-degree warm-up. (Cuddles are the cheapest form of heat I know.)

9. Use a space heater (wisely)

I'm not a huge fan of the small electric heaters. They are good for some things, but quite dangerous in other situations. Use your head on this one, and under no circumstances should you leave one running overnight, in a child's room unattended, or when